● 18:12 VIRAR FAST PF 3

Mumbai Local

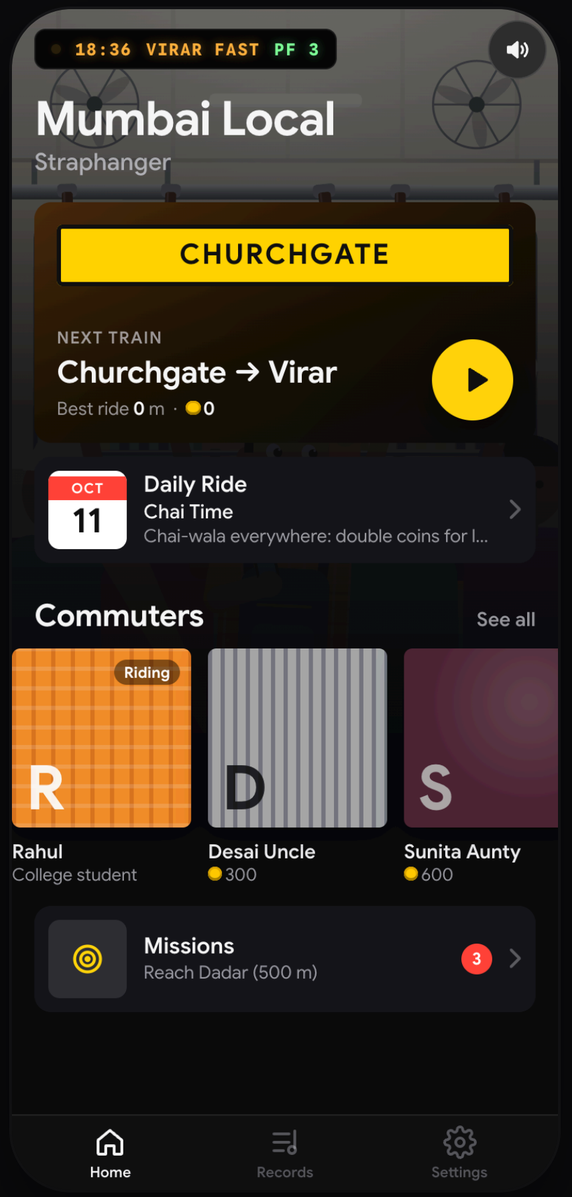
Straphanger

A balance game for phones. It's 6:12 pm on the Virar fast, the compartment is full, and you have **one overhead strap** and two thumbs to stay on your feet from Churchgate to Virar.

PLAY IN YOUR PHONE'S BROWSER

mumbailocalgame.github.io

No install, no sign-in · English, हिन्दी, मराठी





THE CORE OF THE GAME

44°, and the uncle's tiffin is right there.

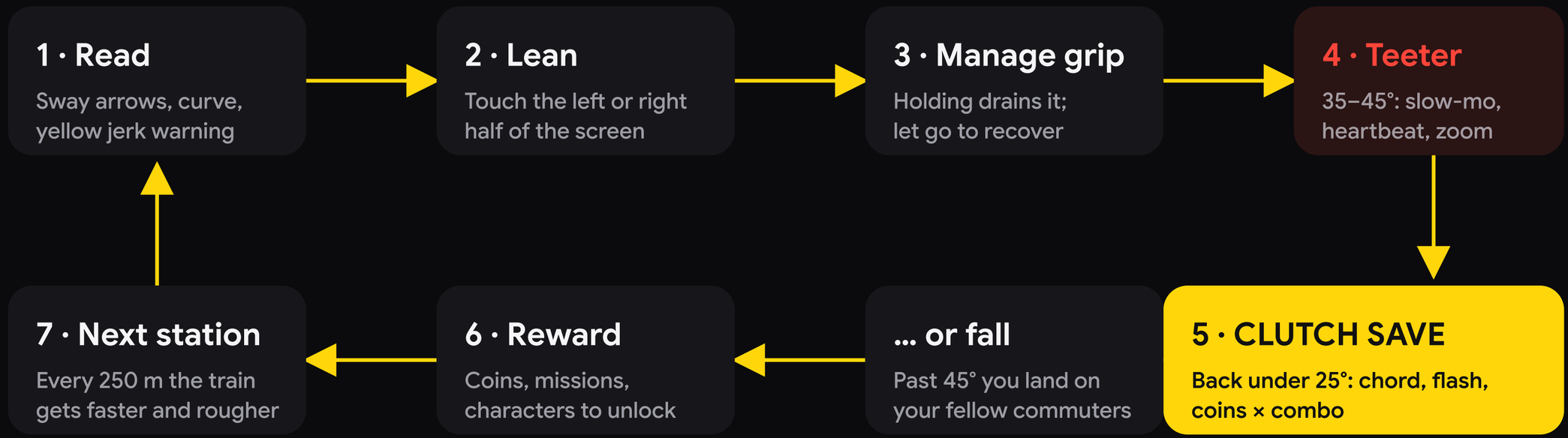
Anyone who has ridden a Mumbai local knows the second when the train lurches, your feet slide, and one leather strap is all that keeps you upright.

The whole game is built around that second. The train shoves you to the red end of the gauge, time slows, a heartbeat starts, and then **you pull yourself back**. We call it the **CLUTCH SAVE**.

Tension, then relief. Every system on the next pages exists to make that moment happen more often, feel fairer, and pay off harder.

CORE LOOP · ONE CYCLE EVERY 2–4 SECONDS

Read the sway. Lean against it. Survive the edge.



Outer loop: each ride ends in a fall. The game-over sheet shows how far along the Western line you got, your coins and finished missions, and one tap starts the next ride.

HOW IT PLAYS

Two halves of a screen. One strap.

Left half	Lean left (push back against a train swaying right)
Right half	Lean right
Both halves	Brace: you stop steering but steady yourself, at double the grip cost
The gauge	Green within ±25°, yellow to 35°, red to 45°. Past 45° you fall.
Grip ring	Blue inner ring. It drains while you hold and refills when you let go. Run out and your hand slips for a moment.

Arrow keys or A/D work on desktop. A short interactive tutorial (about 10 seconds) runs on first launch.



SUPPORTING MECHANICS

Everything feeds the save.

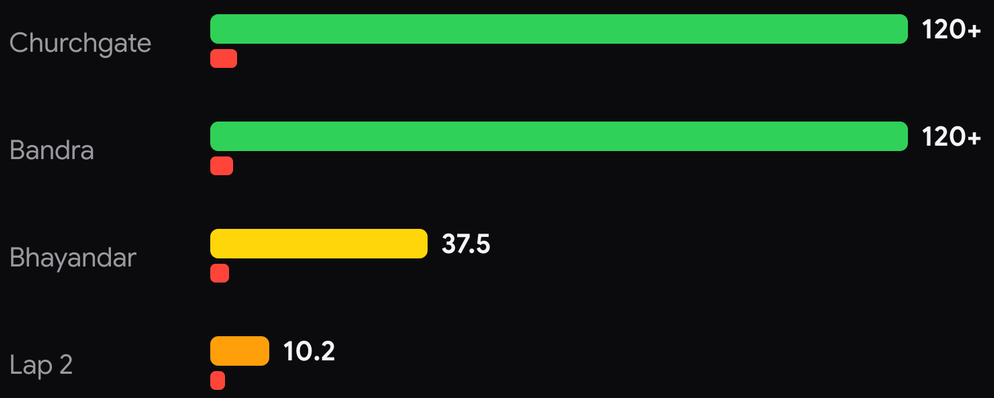
Telegraphed jerks	0.6 s before every jerk, a yellow glow and arrows appear on the side the shove comes from, with a rail-joint "tick". You lose because you misread it, not because it was random.
Danger slow-motion	Past 36° time drops to 68%, the camera pushes in 4%, the screen edges pulse red and a heartbeat speeds up as you near 45°. The dangerous second lasts longer.
Clutch-save combo	Saves within 12 s of each other chain: ×2, ×3… Coins scale with the combo, and the reward chord rises a semitone each step.
Grip stamina	You can't just hold one side forever. Choosing when to let go and rest adds a second decision to the loop.
Stations as rhythm	Every 250 m: BRAKES pushes you one way, then CHALO! pulls you back. The station board slides in, and speed and jerk strength step up.
Ride events (4–9 s)	Tunnel (lights out), Monsoon (grip drains faster), Dadar rush (crowd surge), Sleepy uncle (a steady lean), Chai-wala (stand straight to let him pass).

PROGRESSION & DIFFICULTY

Churchgate is gentle. Bhayandar is not.

Average survival time (seconds, capped at 120)

Early tuning simulation: no input vs. a bot with 220 ms reactions



Every station: speed +1.8 m/s (12 → 32), jerks and sway stronger, steering a little stronger to keep it fair. Red bars show how long you last without touching the screen.

4 commuters

Rahul (balanced), Desai Uncle (pushed 15% less, steers slower), Sunita Aunty (grip lasts longer), Ganesh the dabbawala (quicker, +25% coins).

Missions

Three at a time ("Reach Dadar", "Survive 8 jerks in one ride"). Finishing one pays coins and a new one replaces it.

Daily Ride

The same seeded ride for every player that day, with a twist: Monsoon Special, Ganpati Rush, Fast Local, Chai Time.

Records

Top 10 rides, total distance and a daily streak. +50 coins for the first Daily Ride each day.





THE WORLD

Drawn from the Western line.

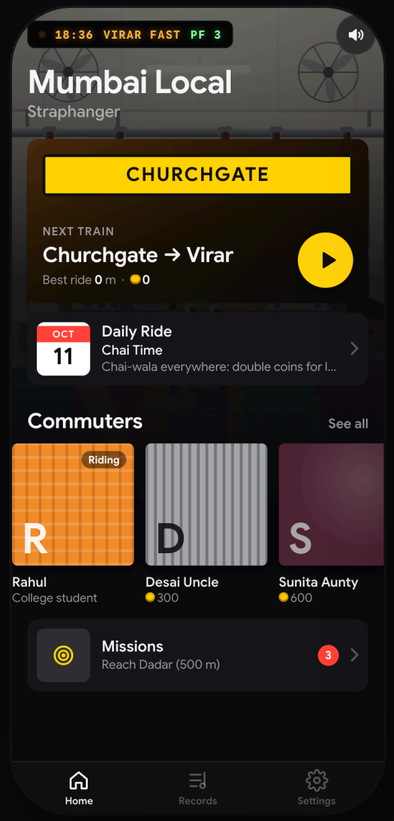
Every detail is code-drawn on a canvas, with no image files:

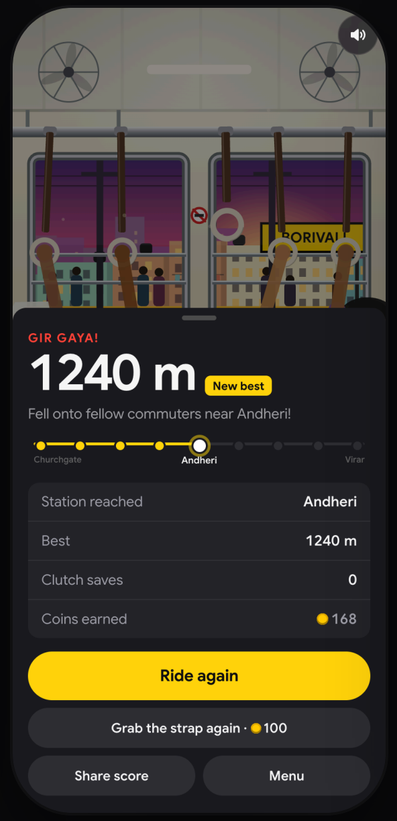
- Backpacks worn on the chest
- Barred windows
- Caged ceiling fans
- Yellow station boards
- Black water tanks on chawl roofs
- Laundry lines
- The chai-wala's steel kettle
- A white Gandhi topi
- Sarees with a pallu
- Evening sky over the chawls

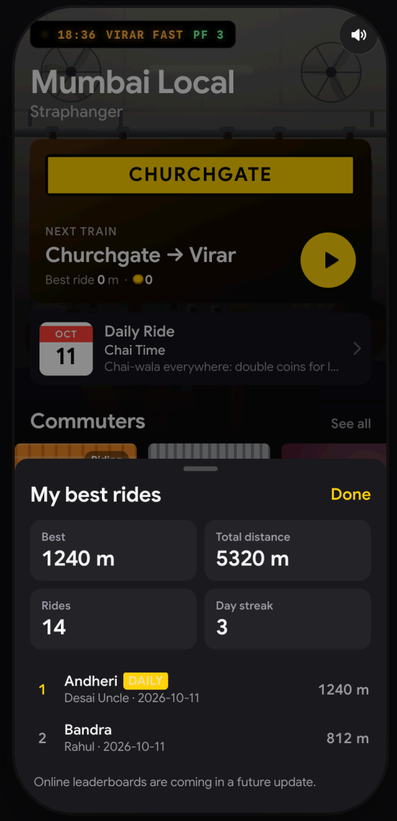
The stops are the real Virar fast stops: Churchgate, Mumbai Central, Dadar, Bandra, Andheri, Borivali, Bhayandar, Vasai Road and Virar. Station names change script with the language.

INTERFACE

A phone app you already know, with railway signage.







Patterns players already know. Large titles, slide-up sheets, iOS switches and a tab bar; a dark music-app home with a round play button and a shelf of commuter "covers".

One accent from the platform. Station-board yellow, never a brand colour. The LED departure board opens the home screen.

Your ride as a route. Game over draws the Western line, filled up to the station where you fell.

Alerts out of the way. Events appear in a black island-style pill at the top, away from the gauge and your thumbs.

SOUND & HAPTICS

All synthesised in the browser. Zero audio files.

Clack-clack

Paired rail-joint clicks whose spacing shrinks as the train speeds up. In tunnels they get louder.

Heartbeat

Starts at 35° and quickens toward 45°. The warning you feel before you see it.

The save chord

A rising four-note arpeggio, a semitone higher for every step of the combo.

Station chime

Three notes on arrival, a brake screech before it, a two-tone horn when you board.

Dhol + shehnai

A dhol groove and a reedy lead in a Bhairav-flavoured scale. The tempo rises with each station.

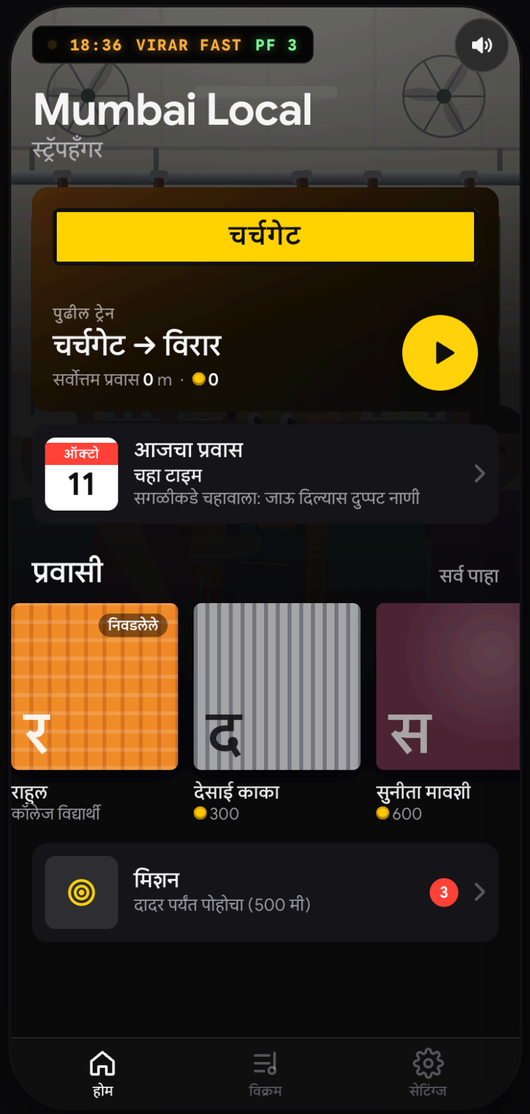
Haptics

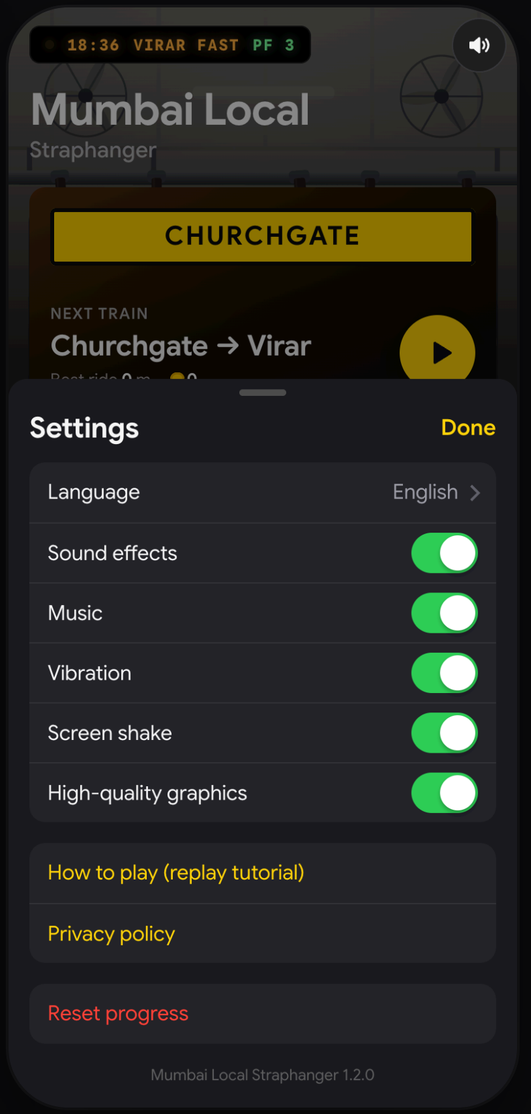
Short taps for jerks, a heavier pulse for saves and falls. Native haptics in the iOS/Android builds.

TECHNOLOGY & ACCESSIBILITY

One HTML file, any phone.

Rendering	HTML5 Canvas 2D at 60 fps, physics in fixed 1/120 s steps, devicePixelRatio-aware
Input	Multi-touch tracked per finger, cleared on blur/background so nothing gets stuck
Light	No external libraries; code ~165 KB plus ~125 KB of fonts. Add to Home Screen on the web; fully offline in the app builds
Languages	English, हिन्दी, मराठी, picked from the phone's language
Comfort	Screen shake, vibration, music and low-graphics mode can each be turned off
App stores	Same code wrapped with Capacitor for iOS and Android





WHAT'S NEXT

What we still need to learn.

Playtesting	Difficulty is tuned with a simulated player. The next step is watching real commuters play on a real train.
Online leaderboards	A global Daily Ride board, so everyone on the same seeded ride can compare.
Central & Harbour lines	New routes with their own rhythm: the Thane curves, the Kurla crush.
Native review	The Hindi and Marathi text should be reviewed by native speakers.

9

stations from Churchgate to Virar

After Virar the train loops back to Churchgate for Lap 2, faster than before.

CHURCHGATE → VIRAR

Hold on tight.

mumbailocalgame.github.io

Open it on a phone, tap the yellow play button, and hold the left or right half of the screen.

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